CLASS 10 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 09

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one discursive passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

On a crowded morning, a flower seller named Kamla found a leather purse near her stall. It contained four thousand rupees, a ration card and a photograph of a smiling woman. For a few minutes she looked at it as one looks at a gift. Then she thought of the owner, who must have been looking for it with a sinking heart, and she carried it to the nearby police post. The owner turned out to be a nurse who had withdrawn her month's salary. She offered Kamla a reward. Kamla refused, saying, 'Take your money, but give me a smile; it is worth more.'

It is easy to praise honesty and just as easy to forget it when we are tempted. The difficulty is that honesty seldom brings an immediate prize. The dishonest man often seems to prosper, while the honest one waits. Yet if we look more closely at people whom we trust, we find that their honesty has made them rich in the only way that matters: when they speak, others listen.

Kamla's act did not make the evening news. She was not offered a reward, and when the nurse tried to give her a note she folded it back into her hand. 'The flowers pay for my day,' she said. 'This was only a thing that belonged to someone else.' The nurse later told her colleagues at the hospital about the incident, and a few of them began to buy their morning garlands from the same stall. In this small way, honesty brought the woman a loyalty that no advertisement could have bought.

Such stories make us ask where the habit of honesty comes from. It is seldom taught through lectures. More often it is caught from watching parents, teachers and neighbours behave honestly when it would have been easier not to. Perhaps the best thing we can do for the next generation is to be, in small things, the people that we wish them to become.

Honesty is also a kind of freedom. A person who tells the truth does not have to remember what he said to whom. He sleeps lightly and wakes without worry. His friends know where they stand with him. A liar, on the other hand, must keep a notebook of his lies in his head and forever fear that the notebook will be found.

Parents can teach this lesson best by example. A child who sees his father return an extra change to the shopkeeper learns more than from a month of sermons. In every home, in every classroom, honesty is taught by the quiet things done when no one is watching.

(i) What did Kamla find near her stall? 1

(a) A gold chain **(b)** A bag of flowers

(c) A purse with money **(d)** A mobile phone

(ii) Where did she take the purse? 1

(a) To the police post **(b)** To the market office

(c) To a temple **(d)** To her home

(iii) The owner of the purse was a: 1

(a) teacher **(b)** nurse **(c)** shopkeeper **(d)** policewoman

(iv) Kamla refused the reward because she: 1

(a) was rich **(b)** was afraid

(c) was told to **(d)** valued the owner's smile more

(v) According to the writer, honesty makes a person: 1

(a) wealthy **(b)** trusted when he speaks

(c) lonely **(d)** famous

(vi) What did the purse contain? 1

(vii) Why is a liar compared to a person with a notebook? 1

(viii) How can parents teach honesty best? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'to become successful'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'rarely'. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage with data/visual input, 200–250 words) 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following advertisement and answer the questions that follow.* 10

A student's lost belongings often cause great worry, and a newspaper notice is one way of finding them. In the third week of October, the following advertisement was published in the 'Lost and Found' column of a local daily. The column offers readers a small space of about forty words, and many people prefer a short, clear message that gives all necessary details at once.

The following advertisement appeared in a local newspaper.

LOST — A BROWN LEATHER SCHOOL BAG

Lost on 12 October on the 7:45 a.m. city bus (Route 14, Station Road to Model School).

Contains: Class 10 notebooks, a geometry box and a blue water bottle with the name 'Rohan' on it.

Reward of ₹ 500 for the finder. Please contact: Rohan Mehta, 24 Park Lane. Phone: 98xx-xxx-210 (after 4 p.m.).

The bag has no money; only the notes are precious.

Two days after the advertisement was published, a conductor of the same bus route called Rohan's number and said that the bag had been handed over to the depot. Rohan collected it in the evening and thanked the man warmly. He later wrote a short note to the newspaper to say that the advertisement had helped him, and that he planned to put his name and address inside all his notebooks in future.

(i) When was the bag lost? 1

(a) 12 November **(b)** 12 October **(c)** 14 October **(d)** 7 November

(ii) Where was it lost? 1

(a) In a shop **(b)** On a city bus

(c) On a train **(d)** At school

(iii) What is the reward offered? 1

(a) ₹ 50 **(b)** ₹ 500 **(c)** ₹ 5,000 **(d)** ₹ 100

(iv) Whose name is written on the water bottle? 1

(v) At what time can the owner be called? 1

(vi) What does the bag contain? 1

(vii) Why does the owner say 'only the notes are precious'? 1

(viii) Which bus route was the student travelling on? 1

(ix) What would be the right action of a person who finds the bag? 1

(x) Find a word in the advertisement which means 'valuable'. 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND